

1625–1789

SPORTING DRESS

Men wore tailored coats for country pursuits such as riding, hunting, hawking, and fishing. Often these activities were social and became sporting occasions as a result. Special occasions demanded special dress, and so sporting dress evolved. Men put on leather boots, breeches, and sometimes a cape or cloak with or without a hood. Women too wore tailored coats – for the first time – for riding. As horseback-riding was the main form of transport, the tailored habit became the principal form of travelling dress, right up to the mid-19th century. Women's tailored jackets and skirts were based on 16th-century garments known as juppes and safeguards – Queen Elizabeth I had these in her wardrobe. For swimming, undergarments and linen caps were worn. A 1675 engraving of the Kings and Queens baths at Bath in England shows women in linen shifts and men topless with linen breeches, all wearing linen caps. The earliest sports to have specific dress were cricket, with *The Sporting Magazine* depicting cricketers in white jackets and breeches in 1793, and golf, for which red jackets were worn.



Tricorn hat with galloon trimming

Short jacket

Tennis racquet

Breeches

Silk stockings

Soft leather shoes

Tennis player Played indoors at this time with cork balls, tennis was known as “the sport of kings”. Light leather shoes were worn to permit players to move quickly, along with a shorter jacket or waistcoat.

Prince Charlie beret of blue wool with red tuft and band

Powdered wig

Short, wool coat

Red became mandatory for golfers

Golfer This golfer wears a beret known as a Prince Charlie or Scotch bonnet, which was worn by Highland Regiments in the mid-18th century. His shortened version of a fashionable coat has sleeves cut close to the arms and minimal decoration for ease of movement.

Silk stockings

